

VALUE ADDITION NOTES

NATIONAL PARK - 1



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PART - 1

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1. Sri Venkateswara National Park

- **Location** - Andhra Pradesh, India.
- **Geography** - The National Park is located in Eastern Ghats spread over the Seshachalam hills of Cuddapah district and Tirumala hills of Chittoor district. The vegetation here is a mix of dry deciduous and moist deciduous types.
- **Important Facts** - As the government of India declared the Seshachalam Hills as one of the biosphere reserves of India in 2010, this national park becomes a part of it.
- **Flora** - The vegetation in the national park consists of dry deciduous mixed forest with patches of moist deciduous forests in the valleys.
- **Fauna** - Endangered yellow-throated and Critically Endangered Oriental white-backed vulture.



2. Namdapha National Park

- **Location** - Arunachal Pradesh, North East India
- **Geography** - The national park is located in Changlang district of the northeastern state of Arunachal Pradesh, near the international border with Myanmar. It is located between the Dapha Bum range of the Mishmi Hills and the Patkai range.
 - It is crossed from east to west by the Noa Dihing River that originates at the Chaukan Pass, located on the Indo-Myanmar border. The land cover changes with increasing elevation from tropical evergreen forest to temperate broadleaf and mixed forest
- **Important Facts** - With more than 1,000 floral and about 1,400 faunal species, it is a biodiversity hotspot in the Eastern Himalayas. The national park harbours the northernmost lowland evergreen rainforests in the world at 27°N latitude
- **Fauna** - Namdapha flying squirrel (It is endemic to the park and critically endangered). leopard, snow leopard, tiger and clouded leopard.





3. Kaziranga National Park

- **Location** - Assam, India
- **Geography** - Kaziranga is one of the largest tracts of protected land in the sub-Himalayan belt, and due to the presence of highly diverse and visible species, has been described as a "biodiversity hotspot".
 - The park is located in the Indomalayan realm, and the dominant ecoregions of the region are Brahmaputra Valley semi-evergreen forests of the tropical and subtropical moist broadleaf forests biome, and the frequently-flooded Terai-Duar savanna and grasslands of the tropical and subtropical grasslands, savannas, and shrublands biome.
 - Kaziranga is also surrounded by lush green tea plantations, most of them contributing heavily to Assam's economy.

- **Important Facts** - The sanctuary, which hosts two-thirds of the world's great one-horned rhinoceroses, is a World Heritage Site. The park is home to large breeding populations of elephants, wild water buffalo, and swamp deer.
- Kaziranga is recognized as an **Important Bird Area by BirdLife International for conservation of avifaunal species**. When compared with other protected areas in India, Kaziranga has achieved notable success in wildlife conservation. Located on the edge of the Eastern Himalaya biodiversity hotspot, the park combines high species diversity and visibility.
- **Flora** - Kaziranga is a vast expanse of tall elephant grass, marshland, and dense tropical moist broadleaf forests, criss-crossed by four major rivers, including the Brahmaputra, and the park includes numerous small bodies of water. Four main types of vegetation exist in this park.
 - These are alluvial inundated grasslands, alluvial savanna woodlands, tropical moist mixed deciduous forests, and tropical semi-evergreen forests.
- **Fauna** - The park has the distinction of being home to the world's largest population of the Greater One-Horned Rhinoceros, wild Asiatic water buffalo and eastern swamp deer.
 - Significant populations of large herbivores include Indian elephants, gaur and sambar. Small herbivores include the Indian muntjac, wild boar, and hog deer. Kaziranga has the largest population of the Wild water buffalo anywhere accounting for about 57% of the world population.

- The One-Horned rhinoceros, Royal Bengal Tiger, Asian elephant, wild water buffalo and swamp deer are collectively known as the '**Big Five**' of Kaziranga.

Kaziranga was declared a Tiger Reserve in 2006. Small mammals include the rare hispid hare, Indian gray mongoose, small Indian mongooses, large Indian civet, small Indian civets, Bengal fox, golden jackal, sloth bear, Chinese pangolin, Indian pangolins, hog badger, Chinese ferret badgers, and particoloured flying squirrel. Kaziranga's rivers are also home to the endangered Ganges dolphin.



4. Dibru-Saikhowa National Park

- **Location** - Assam, India
- **Geography** - The park is bounded by the Brahmaputra and Lohit Rivers in the north and Dibru river in the south. It mainly consists of moist mixed semi-evergreen forests, moist mixed deciduous forests, canebrakes and grasslands.
- **Important Facts** - It was designated a Biosphere Reserve in July 1997.
- **Flora** - The forest of Dibru-Saikhowa consists of semi-evergreen forests, deciduous, littoral and swamp forests and patches of wet evergreen forests
- **Fauna** - Species include Bengal tiger, Indian leopard, clouded leopard, jungle cat, sloth bear, dhole, small Indian civet, Malayan giant squirrel, Chinese pangolin, Gangetic dolphin, slow loris, pig tailed macaque,



5. Manas National Park

- **Location** - Assam, India
- **Geography** - Manas is located in the foothills of the Eastern Himalaya and is densely forested. The Manas river flows through the west of the park and is the main river within it. It is a major tributary of Brahmaputra river and splits into two separate rivers, the Bwrsi and Bholkaduba as it reaches the plains.
 - The Manas river also serves as an international border dividing India and Bhutan. The bedrock of the savanna area in the north of the park is made up of limestone and sandstone, whereas the grasslands in the south of the park stand on deep deposits of fine alluvium.
- **Important Facts** - Manas National Park or Manas Wildlife Sanctuary is a UNESCO Natural World Heritage site, a Project Tiger reserve, an elephant reserve and a biosphere reserve in Assam, India. Located in the Himalayan foothills, it is contiguous with the Royal Manas National Park in Bhutan.
- **Flora** - The monsoon forests of Manas lie in the Brahmaputra Valley semi-evergreen forests ecoregion. The combination of Sub-Himalayan Bhabar Terai formation with riverine succession leading up to the Himalayan subtropical broadleaf forests makes it one of the richest biodiversity areas in the world.
 - The main vegetation types are:

- Sub-Himalayan Light Alluvial Semi-Evergreen forests in the northern parts.
 - East Himalayan mixed Moist and Dry Deciduous forests (the most common type).
 - Low Alluvial Savanna Woodland, and
 - Assam Valley Semi-Evergreen Alluvial Grasslands which cover almost 50% of the park.
- **Fauna** - The park is known for its rare and endangered endemic wildlife such as the Assam roofed turtle, hispid hare, golden langur and pygmy hog. Manas is famous for its population of the wild water buffalo.
 - The park is well known for species of rare and endangered wildlife that are not found anywhere else in the world like the Assam roofed turtle, hispid hare, golden langur and pygmy hog.



6. Orang National Park

- **Location** - Assam, India
- **Geography** - The park is formed of alluvial flood plains of the many rivers and is an integral part of the Indo-Burma biodiversity hotspot.
 - The total area of the park has been categorized into:
 - Eastern Himalayan Moist Deciduous Forest; Eastern Seasonal Swamp Forest, Eastern Wet Alluvial Grassland, Savannah Grassland, Degraded Grassland, Water body, Moist Sandy area and Dry Sandy area.
- **Important Facts** - It is located on the northern bank of the Brahmaputra River in the Darrang and Sonitpur districts of Assam.
- **Fauna** - It has a rich flora and fauna, including great Indian rhinoceros, pygmy hog, Asian elephant, wild water buffalo and Bengal tiger.



7. Dehing-Patkai National Park

- **Location** - Assam, India
- **Geography** - It is located in the Dehing patkai landscape which is a dipterocarp-dominated lowland rainforest.
- **Important Facts** - The Dehing Patkai forms the largest stretch of lowland rainforests in India. The Dehing Patkai Wildlife Sanctuary was declared as Dehing-Patkai Elephant Reserve under Project Elephant.
- **Flora** - Being a completely virgin rainforest, this sanctuary is very rich in biodiversity. It is an ideal habitat for non-human primates.
- **Fauna** - The most common mammal species of this sanctuary are hoolock gibbon, slow loris, Assamese macaque, stump-tailed macaque, capped langur, Asian elephant, Bengal tiger, Indian leopard, gaur, Chinese pangolin, Himalayan black bear, Red giant flying squirrel, leopard cat, clouded leopard, porcupine, crab eating mongoose, sambar, sun bear, binturong, barking deer, Asian golden cat and marbled cat



8. Valmiki National Park

- **Location** - Bihar, India
- **Geography** - The landscape of VTR encompasses foothills ranges of Himalayan Sivaliks with mosaic of the cliffs, ridges, gorges, hills, streams and valleys; dense forests, open woodlands, grasslands, swamps and riverine fringe.
 - Situated in Gangetic plains bio-geographic zone of the Country, the forest has combination of bhabar and terai tracts. Boulder and pebble deposits by the Himalayan rivers in foothills characterized the Bhabar tract while the finer sediment deposits feature Terai lands.
- **Important Facts** - located at the India-Nepal border in the West Champaran district of Bihar, India on the bank of river Gandak. It is the only National park in Bihar.
- **Fauna** - The wildlife found in the forest of VTR are the Bengal tiger, Indian rhinoceros, Asiatic black bear, Indian sloth bear, otter, Indian leopard, wild dog, wild water buffalo, and wild boar.
 - There are several species of deer, including barking deer, spotted deer, hog deer, Sambar, blue bull. Apart from that the striped hyena, leopard cat, fishing cat, langur, monkey, flying squirrel, clouded leopard, Indian gaur, mongoose can also be sighted.



9. Indravati National Park

- **Location** - Chhattisgarh, India
- **Important Facts** - It derives its name from the nearby Indravati River. It is home to one of the last populations of rare wild buffalo.
- **Flora** - The vegetation of the Indravati National Park is mainly of the tropical moist and dry deciduous type with predominance of bamboo, sal and teak.
 - There are also rich patches of luxuriant grassland providing plenty of food to large herbivores such as wild water buffalos, chital, barking deer, nilgai, and gaurs. The most common trees in the park are teak, lendia, salai, mahua, tendu, semal, haldu, ber and jamun.
- **Fauna** - Indravati National Park has one of the last populations of the endangered wild Asian buffalo.

- Reported from the area are gaur (Indian bison), nilgai, blackbuck, chausingha (four-horned antelope), sambar, chital, Indian muntjac, Indian spotted chevrotain and wild boar.
- Large predators are represented by tigers, leopards, sloth bears, dholes (wild dogs) and striped hyenas.



10. Gir Forest National Park

- **Location** - Gujarat, India
- **Geography** - The seven major perennial rivers of the Gir region are Hiran, Shetrunji, Datardi, Shingoda, Machhundri, Godavari and Raval.

- The four reservoirs of the area are at **four dams, one each on Hiran, Machhundri, Raval and Shingoda rivers, including the biggest reservoir in the area, the Kamleshwar Dam, dubbed 'the lifeline of Gir'.**
- **Important Facts** - Asiatic Lions are only Found here
- **Flora** - The Gir forest area is a very dry teak forest. Teak occurs mixed with dry deciduous species. It is part of the Khathiar-Gir dry deciduous forests ecoregion
- **Fauna** - Mainly comprises the Asiatic lion, Indian leopard, jungle cat, striped hyena, golden jackal, Bengal fox, Indian gray mongoose and ruddy mongoose, and honey badger. Asiatic wildcat and rusty-spotted cats occur, but are rarely seen.



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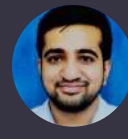
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